

MI Little Care

Provider Portal

LICENSED FAMILY & GROUP CHILD CARE HOMES

The Provider *Manual*

Running your licensed home, staying inspection-ready, and getting paid — in one place.

Aligned with Michigan's 2026 Child Care Home Licensing Rules • R 400.1901–1963, effective April 27, 2026
Edition 3 • June 2026

What's inside

1 Welcome & how to use this manual

Who this is for, and the fastest path to set up

2 Your dashboard

The home screen and daily attendance

3 Set it once: Business Info

Hours, fees, licensing, and what parents see

4 Families, children & the intake packet

Enrolling families and the R 400.1907 child record

5 The Compliance Checklist

Your inspection-readiness scoreboard

6 Staff Training & your roster

Every caregiver, every requirement, every due date

7 MiRegistry

Your training transcript and state ID

8 Reminders: your compliance calendar

Drills, renewals, and reviews that never slip

9 Messages & parent communication

Per-child threads and photo sharing

10 Getting paid & parent acknowledgments

Billing, confirmations, and CDC I-Billing

11 How money works

Payments, security, and the 1099-K

12 What's new in the 2026 rules

The changes every licensed home should know

1 Welcome

START HERE

MI Little Care is built for one job: to let a licensed family or group child care home run its day, stay ready for inspection, and get paid — without juggling a binder, a spreadsheet, and three apps.

This manual is written for **licensed family and group child care home providers** in Michigan — not license-exempt providers. Everywhere the app references a rule, it points to Michigan's licensing rules for family and group child care homes (R 400.1901–1963), as revised and adopted **April 27, 2026**. If you hold a regular or original license for a family or group home, this manual is for you.

The fastest way to get set up

If you do nothing else in your first sitting, do these four things — in this order. Everything else builds on them.

1. **Fill in Business Info** (Section 3). Your hours, fees, and licensing details flow automatically to every parent's portal.
2. **Add your families and children**, and complete each child's **intake packet** (Section 4). This is the R 400.1907 child record an inspector will ask for.
3. **Add your caregivers to Staff Training** (Section 6) so the app can track CPR, background checks, and training hours for everyone under your license.
4. **Turn on the Reminders you want** (Section 8) so drills, renewals, and record reviews never slip past you.

Once those are in place, the **Compliance Checklist** (Section 5) becomes your single source of truth for “am I ready if a licensing consultant walked in today?”

A NOTE ON THIS EDITION

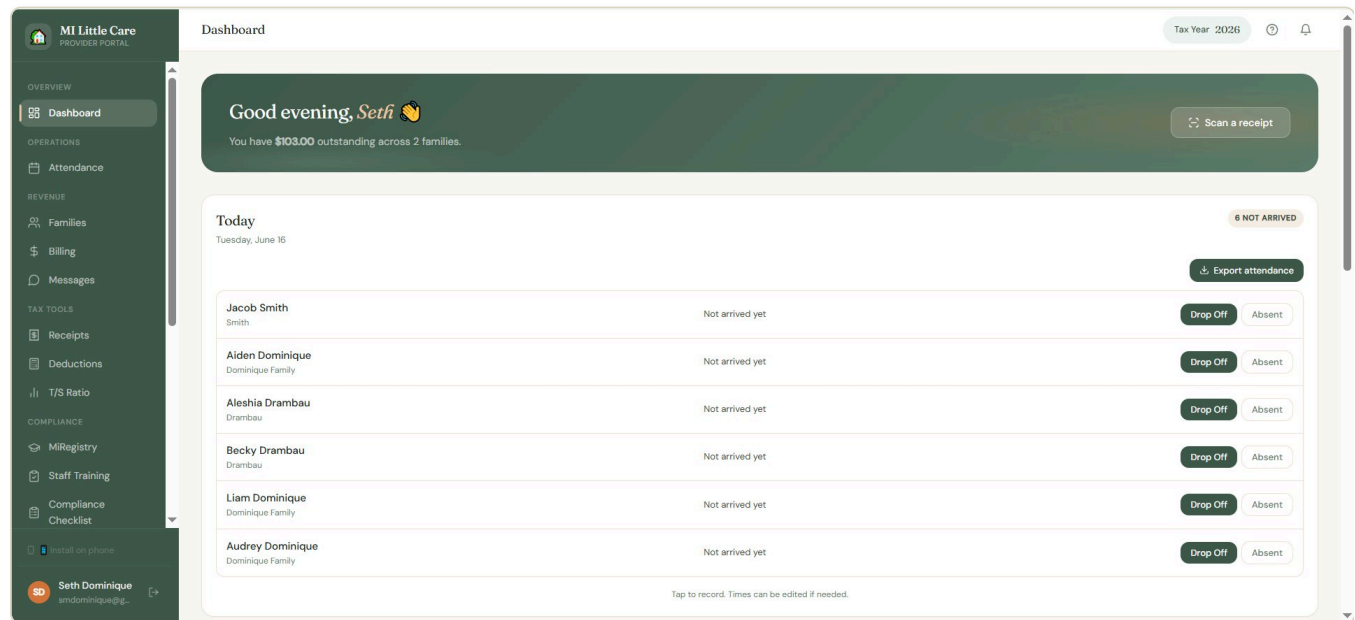
This manual reflects the 2026 licensing rules. If you previously used a version written for license-exempt providers, set it aside — the training hours, deadlines, and record requirements described here are the ones that apply to your *licensed* home.

2 Your dashboard

YOUR HOME SCREEN

When you sign in, the dashboard is your home base. The green banner greets you and surfaces anything outstanding — for example, a balance owed across your families — and gives you a one-tap **Scan a receipt** shortcut for tracking deductible expenses.

Below that, the **Today** panel is your live attendance sheet. Each enrolled child appears with a **Drop Off** and an **Absent** button. Tapping records the arrival time; you can edit times afterward if you need to. The count in the corner (“6 not arrived”) tells you at a glance who you're still expecting.



The provider dashboard: outstanding-balance banner, receipt scanner, and the live Today attendance panel.

Daily attendance isn't just convenient — it's a licensing requirement. Under R 400.1907(3), you must keep dated daily attendance records showing each child's name and arrival and departure times, and the rule explicitly allows electronic records. Recording attendance here each day satisfies that requirement and builds the history your reports draw on.

The navigation menu

The left sidebar groups everything into sections you'll come to know: **Overview** (Dashboard), **Operations** (Attendance), **Revenue** (Families, Billing, Messages), **Tax Tools** (Receipts, Deductions, T/S Ratio), **Compliance** (MiRegistry, Staff Training, Compliance Checklist, Parent Acknowledgments, CDC Pay Periods, CDC I-Billing), and **Settings** (Business Info, Team, Reminders, Subscription, and more). This manual walks the ones that matter most, in the order you'll use them.

3 Set it once: Business Info

CONFIGURATION THAT FLOWS TO PARENTS

“Set this once. Stop answering it forever.” Everything you enter in Business Info shows up automatically on every parent’s portal — no more “what time do you open?” texts.

Business Info is organized into tabs across the top of the page. Work through them left to right; a green check marks each one you've completed:

Tab	What it sets
Business name	The name parents see in their portal and on invoices. Set this first — it's your brand.
Hours	Your operating hours per day. Days you mark closed show as closed to parents.
Holidays & Closures	Planned closures, so families know in advance.
Payment & Fees	Your rates and payment terms.
Emergency Info	Emergency contacts and procedures.
Parent Messages	Standing information you want every parent to see.
Licensing	Your license details.
Premises / Property	Details about your home and child-use space.
What applies?	Applicability questions that tailor your compliance items to your home.

The screenshot displays the 'Business Info' section of the 'MI Little Care PROVIDER PORTAL'. The 'Hours' tab is active, showing a checklist of setup items: Business name, Hours, Holidays & Closures, Payment & Fees, Emergency Info, Parent Messages, Licensing, Premises, What applies?, and Property. Each item has a green checkmark indicating it is completed. The 'Operating Hours' section allows setting hours for each day of the week. Sunday and Saturday are marked as 'CLOSED'. Monday through Friday are set to open at 07:00 AM and close at 06:00 PM. The interface includes a sidebar with navigation options like Receipts, Deductions, T/S Ratio, Compliance, MiRegistry, Staff Training, Compliance Checklist, Parent Acknowledgments, CDC Pay Periods, CDC I-Billing, SETTINGS, Business Info, Team, Reminders, Subscription, and a user profile for Seth Dominique.

Business Info with the Hours tab open. The tab row across the top is your full setup checklist; green checks show what's done.

The **Hours** tab is a good example of the “set once” idea: toggle each day on or off and set open/close times. Saturday and Sunday default to closed. Whatever you set here is exactly what parents see, so you never field a scheduling question twice.

TIP

The *What applies?* tab is worth a careful pass. Your answers there tell the Compliance Checklist which items are relevant to your specific home — for instance, whether a lead-paint disclosure applies because your home was built before 1978. Answering it well keeps your checklist focused on what actually applies to you.

4 Families, children & the intake packet

ENROLLMENT AND THE CHILD RECORD

Families live under **Families** in the Revenue section. Open a family and you'll find tabs for **Overview, Access, Children, Funding, Guardians, Emergency, Attendance, and Compliance** — everything about that household in one place.

Inviting parents — and seeing what they see

On the **Access** tab you invite a parent or guardian to view invoices, pay online, and manage their family info. Each guardian is invited separately, and invitations expire after 7 days (so if an old invite stops working, just send a fresh one). You'll see each person's status — **Accepted** or **Revoked** — so you always know who currently has access.

The screenshot shows the 'Dominique Family' interface with the 'Access' tab selected. The 'Family Access' section includes a 'Preview as Parent' button and a '+ Send invitation' button. Below this, a list of guardians is displayed with their status and acceptance dates.

Guardian	Status	Accepted Date
Katie Dominique	ACCEPTED	6/2/2026
Bob	ACCEPTED	5/5/2026
Seth Dominique	ACCEPTED	5/2/2026
Katie	REVOKED	
Seth	ACCEPTED	4/30/2026

A family's Access tab. Note the per-guardian status and the Preview as Parent button.

PREVIEW AS PARENT

See the **Preview as Parent** button? Use it whenever a parent says “I can't find my invoice” or you just want to confirm the information reaching a family is accurate. It shows you exactly what that parent sees in their portal — the fastest way to troubleshoot a parent-side question without guessing.

The intake packet (the R 400.1907 child record)

Before a child's first day, Michigan requires you to collect a specific set of records — the “child in care statement” under R 400.1907. In MI Little Care you capture this per child: open the child from their family and choose **Intake**. The app presents one acknowledgment envelope with a row for each required item, and it only shows the disclosures that actually apply to that child.

Record intake for Aiden



Tell the parent you can provide them a copy of the licensing rules (R 400.1901–1951) on request.

Condition of child health acknowledged

Capture the parent acknowledging the child's general health and any conditions you should know about.

Notes on the child's health, conditions, allergies...



Discipline policy received

Confirm the parent received your written discipline policy.

Infant safe-sleep practices

Required for children under 18 months. Cover back-sleeping, no soft bedding, and supervision.

How is the parent acknowledging?

- ☒ Parent signed in person / on paper
- ☐ I am recording on the parent's behalf
- ☐ Send to parent's portal (we will email them a link to confirm)

Parent name (as signed on paper)

Close

Save intake bundle

The intake packet for a child. The app surfaces only the disclosures that apply — here, lead-based paint shows because the home predates 1978.

The packet covers every element R 400.1907 requires:

- **Licensing rules offered** — you tell the parent a copy of the rules (R 400.1901–1951) is available on request.
- **Condition of child health acknowledged** — with a notes field for conditions and allergies.
- **Discipline policy received** — confirming the parent got your written policy.
- **Agreement on who provides food** — you, the parent, or both.
- **Firearms-on-premises disclosure** — required at intake regardless of whether the answer is yes or no.
- **Lead-based paint disclosure** — shown only if your home was built before 1978.
- **Licensing notebook availability** — you tell the parent your notebook is available during operating hours.
- **Infant safe-sleep practices** — shown only for children under 18 months.
- **Immunization documentation** — completed, in progress, or waived.

You then choose **how** the parent is acknowledging: signed in person on paper, recorded on the parent's behalf, or sent to the parent's portal for them to confirm by email. The result saves as a single signed intake packet. Records must be reviewed and updated annually (R 400.1907(2)), and the app's reminders will prompt you when a review comes due.

NEW IN 2026

The **licensing-notebook** acknowledgment reflects a 2026 addition: under R 400.1906(3), your home must keep a current licensing notebook (inspection reports, corrective-action plans, and approval letters for the last three years) that is accessible to parents. The intake packet records that you've made parents aware of it.

5 The Compliance Checklist

YOUR INSPECTION-READINESS SCOREBOARD

This is the screen that answers the question every provider quietly carries: “If a licensing consultant walked in right now, would I be ready?”

The Compliance Checklist is a read-only view of what's on file, what's missing, and what still needs your input. At the top, a five-number scorecard gives you the state of your whole home at a glance: **On file**, **Missing**, **Expired**, **Pending parent**, and **Awaiting input**.

MI Little Care
PROVIDER PORTAL

MI Little Care

Tax Year: 2026

Compliance Checklist

Read-only view of what's on file, what's missing, and what still needs your input. Answer applicability questions →

25	64	0	17	22
On file	Missing	Expired	Pending parent	Awaiting input

Print for inspection prep

Provider-level

Staff files (R 400.1919–1924) 5 missing · 3 unknown

- Background check eligibility (per caregiver)
Missing — needs staff record
Record this caregiver's background-check eligibility result. R 400.1919 + R 400.1903(1)(r). An eligible determination is required BEFORE unsupervised contact with children.
Open Staff Training →
R 400.1919 / R 400.1903(1)(r)
- CPR + pediatric first aid currency (per caregiver)
Missing — needs staff record
Record this caregiver's current CPR + pediatric first-aid certification (the expiration date printed on their card). R 400.1924(8) + R 400.1920(3) / R 400.1921(3).
Open Staff Training →
R 400.1924(8)
- New-hire 14-topic training (per caregiver, 90-day deadline)
Missing — needs staff record

The Compliance Checklist scorecard and provider-level items. Each item carries a plain-English explanation, an action link, and its rule citation.

Items are grouped the way an inspector thinks — for example, **Staff files (R 400.1919–1924)** — and each one tells you exactly what's needed and why. A missing background-check eligibility item, for instance, explains that an eligible determination is required *before* unsupervised contact with children, cites the rule, and gives you an **Open Staff Training** → button that takes you straight to where you fix it.

YOUR CITATIONS ARE CURRENT

Every item on this screen cites the **2026** rule numbering — R 400.1919 for background checks, R 400.1924 for professional development, and so on. The checklist is built against the rules that took effect April 27, 2026, so what it asks of you matches what your licensing consultant is working from.

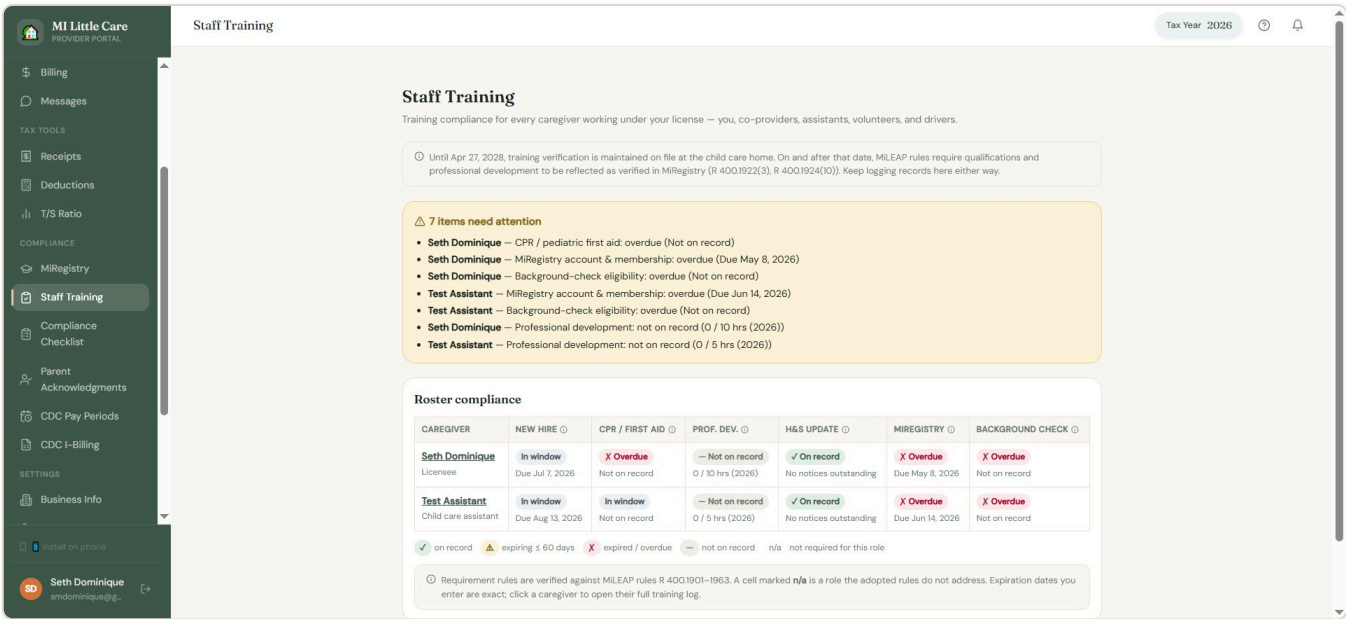
Print for inspection prep

The **Print for inspection prep** button turns the checklist into a clean document you can use to walk your home before a visit — or hand to a consultant. It's the single most useful thing you can do the week before a renewal or an announced inspection.

6 Staff Training & your roster

EVERY CAREGIVER, EVERY REQUIREMENT

Staff Training tracks compliance for **every** caregiver working under your license — you, co-providers, assistants, volunteers, and drivers. The page opens with an **items-need-attention** list (anything overdue or not on record), then the heart of the screen: the **Roster compliance matrix**.



The Staff Training roster: one row per caregiver, one column per requirement, with exact due dates and clear status.

Each row is a caregiver; each column is a requirement, verified against the 2026 rules:

Column	What it tracks	Rule
New Hire	The 14-topic new-hire training, due within 90 days of being present and before caring for children unsupervised.	R 400.1923
CPR / First Aid	Current pediatric CPR and pediatric first-aid certification, by the date on the card.	R 400.1920(3), 1921(3)
Prof. Dev.	Professional-development hours: 10/year for the licensee, 5/year for staff, by calendar year.	R 400.1924
H&S Update	Health-and-safety update documents published on MiRegistry.	R 400.1924(11)
MiRegistry	An active MiRegistry account and membership, required within 30 days of employment.	R 400.1922
Background Check	An eligible determination before any unsupervised contact with children.	R 400.1919

Cells are color-coded — on record, expiring within 60 days, expired/overdue, not on record, or not required for that role — with the exact due date under each. Click any caregiver to open their full training log. Expiration dates you enter are exact, so the roster (and your reminders) fire on the right day.

TWO 2026 CHANGES WORTH KNOWING

CPR and first aid now count toward professional-development hours (R 400.1924(5)) — they didn't before. And the staff age floor dropped: a child care staff member may now be **16 or older** (was 18), and a child care assistant is now **14–15** (was 14–17).

LOOKING AHEAD: MIREGISTRY VERIFICATION

Until **April 27, 2028**, you may keep training verification on file at your home. On and after that date, the rules require qualifications and professional development to be reflected as verified in MiRegistry (R 400.1922(3), R 400.1924(10)). Keep logging records here either way — you'll be ready when the change lands.

7 MiRegistry

YOUR TRAINING TRANSCRIPT

The MiRegistry section is your *personal* training record — distinct from the Staff Training roster, which covers your whole team. Here you keep your own logged trainings, each with a completion date and hours, and your MiRegistry ID.

Use **Log a training** to record a session from your MiRegistry transcript — past trainings work too, since the completion date determines which calendar year they count toward. Logged trainings flow into the matching column on your Staff Training roster, so an hour recorded here moves your professional-development total toward the 10 hours (licensee) or 5 hours (staff) the rules require under R 400.1924.

A HEADS-UP ON TRAINING CATEGORIES

The categories in *Log a training* are being updated to match the licensed family/group-home requirements (R 400.1923/1924).

When you log professional-development hours, the goal is for them to land in the Prof. Dev. column of your roster and count toward your annual total. If a category label looks like it was written for a different provider type, check back — this area is being refreshed to the licensed-home rules.

8 Reminders: your compliance calendar

NOTHING SLIPS

Every recurring obligation in the licensing rules has a date attached to it. Reminders is the feature that watches all of those dates for you, so a drill or a renewal never falls through the cracks.

Reminders are opt-in. Turn on the categories you want, choose how far in advance you want the heads-up, and pick where to receive it — an in-app banner, email, or both. Most are off by default; a few that fire automatically when you take an action that triggers them are marked “On unless you opt out.”

Reminders

Compliance reminders are opt-in. Turn on the categories you want, pick how far in advance you want the heads-up, and choose where to receive it. Most are off by default; a few marked “On unless you opt out” fire automatically when you take an explicit action that triggers them.

- ☒ **Annual child-records review due**
Per R 400.1907, every child's records must be reviewed at least once a year. Fires N days before the anniversary of children.records_last_reviewed_on (or, for never-reviewed children, N days after children.intake_completed_at).
SEND THE REMINDER: 30 days before | WHERE TO SEND IT: In-app banner + email
- ☒ **Email parents when I send acknowledgment requests** On unless you opt out
Fires when the licensee has triggered parent-portal collection of an intake acknowledgment (PR #16 § 8.6 parent-portal extension) and the parent has not completed it. Subject is the affected child; the per-acknowledgment row carries the disclosure type. Fires immediately on trigger (lead 0) and is cleared on parent confirm.
SEND THE REMINDER: 7 days before | WHERE TO SEND IT: In-app banner + email
- ☒ **New hire owes discipline-policy acknowledgment**
Per R 400.1906 / R 400.1942, every personnel member must acknowledge the discipline policy at hire. Fires when caregivers.date_of_hire is set and no active staff_discipline_policy_receipt acknowledgment exists for that caregiver. Lead 0 = fires on the hire date; PR #17 also marks ack stale when the policy version bumps (see scope § 8.4).

The Reminders settings. Each reminder is tied to a specific rule and a computed due date.

The reminders cover the full calendar of a licensed home:

Reminder	What it watches	Rule
Annual child-records review	Each child's records reviewed at least yearly.	R 400.1907
CPR / first aid expiring	Per-caregiver certification currency.	R 400.1920(3), 1924(8)
Physician attestation renewal	Annual health attestation for each caregiver and you.	R 400.1933
Fire drill due	Every 3 months (4 per year).	R 400.1939
Tornado drill due	Two per year, March–November.	R 400.1939
Annual drill due	Lockdown / shelter-in-place / reunification.	R 400.1939
Medication re-acknowledgment	When an authorization ends or its dose/schedule changes.	R 400.1931
Radon test due	Every 4 years.	R 400.1915
Heating inspection due	Every 4 years.	R 400.1945
Smoke / CO detector check	Annual best-practice check.	R 400.1948
New-hire discipline-policy ack	Each new caregiver acknowledges your discipline policy at hire.	R 400.1906, 1942

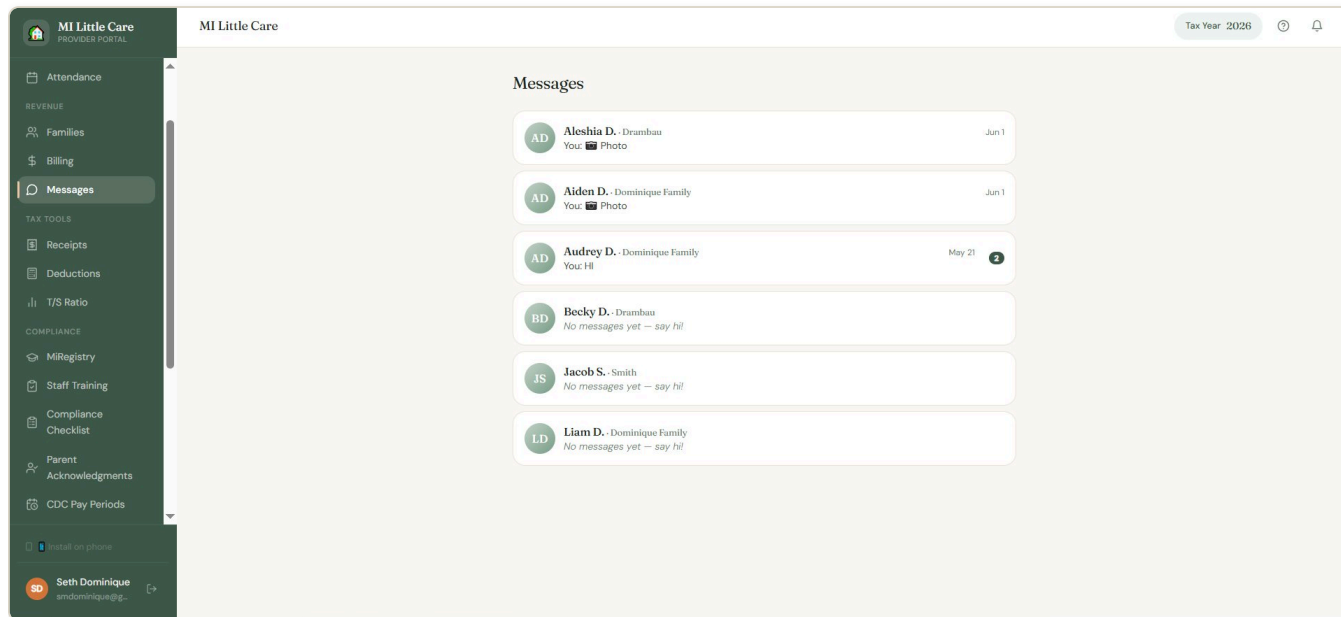
SET THESE ON DAY ONE

The drills and the 4-year items (radon, heating) are the ones providers most often forget, because they come around so rarely. Turn those on now and the app will carry the dates for you — you'll get a banner weeks ahead instead of discovering a lapse at renewal.

9 Messages & parent communication

ONE PLACE TO STAY IN TOUCH

Messages gives you a threaded conversation for each child, tagged with their family. You'll see the latest message preview, a timestamp, and an unread badge when a parent has written. Empty threads are ready and waiting (“No messages yet — say hi!”) so you can reach any family in a tap.



The Messages inbox: one thread per child, with photo sharing and unread counts.

You can share **photos** through a thread — a simple way to send parents a moment from their child's day.

PHOTOS RESPECT CONSENT

Photo sharing honors each child's photo-consent setting. If a photo won't send for a particular child, it's because that family hasn't given photo consent yet — not a glitch. Once the parent consents, sharing works normally.

10 Getting paid & parent acknowledgments

BILLING AND CONFIRMATIONS

You invoice families from **Billing**, and parents pay online (more on the mechanics and security in Section 11). Two features support the billing side specifically for providers who serve CDC-subsidy families.

Parent Acknowledgments

Despite the name, this is a **billing-hours confirmation** tool, not a licensing feature. Parents review and confirm their billed hours from their portal, and you can override or resolve disputes here. A 30-day scoreboard tracks what's been **confirmed**, **overridden**, **flagged**, **needs re-confirm**, or **unacknowledged**.

The screenshot shows the 'Parent Acknowledgments' settings page in the MI Little Care Provider Portal. The page has a dark green sidebar with navigation links: Receipts, Deductions, T/S Ratio, COMPLIANCE (MIRegistry, Staff Training, Compliance Checklist), Parent Acknowledgments (selected), CDC Pay Periods, CDC I-Billing, SETTINGS (Business Info, Team, Reminders, Subscription), and a bottom section with 'Install on phone' and a user profile for Seth Dominique. The main content area is titled 'Parent Acknowledgments' and includes a subtitle: 'Last 30 days. Parents review and confirm billed hours from the parent portal; you can override or resolve disputes here.' Below this is a 'Settings' section with a description: 'Controls when and how parents are reminded to review billed hours. Strict mode blocks I-Billing export when any billed day is unacknowledged.' The settings are organized into three columns: 'Email reminders' (with a checked box for 'Send weekly/daily digest emails to parents'), 'Cadence' (set to 'Weekly'), and 'Strictness' (set to 'Warning — surface unacknowledged'). The second row includes 'Send day' (set to 'Friday'), 'Send hour (provider local time)' (set to '5:00 PM'), and 'Timezone (IANA)' (set to 'America/Detroit'). A 'Save settings' button is at the bottom of the settings section. Below the settings is a 'This 30-day window' scoreboard with five categories, each with a circular counter showing '0': 'CONFIRMED BY PARENT' (green), 'PROVIDER OVERRIDE' (grey), 'FLAGGED BY PARENT' (yellow), 'NEEDS RE-CONFIRM (EDITED)' (orange), and 'UNACKNOWLEDGED' (red). At the bottom is an 'Active flags' section with a green checkmark icon and the text 'No active flags. Disputes from parents will appear here.'

Parent Acknowledgments: reminder cadence, a strictness setting, and the 30-day confirmation scoreboard.

You control how parents are reminded — cadence, send day and hour, and a **strictness** setting. In its strict mode, the system blocks a CDC I-Billing export whenever any billed day is still unacknowledged, which keeps your billing clean before it goes out. This connects directly to **CDC I-Billing** and **CDC Pay Periods** in the Compliance section for providers billing the Child Development and Care program.

WHY THIS MATTERS

If you bill CDC, having parents confirm their hours before export gives you a documented trail and reduces the chance of a billing dispute later. Set the reminder cadence to match your pay periods so confirmations come in before you need to file.

11 How money works

PAYMENTS, SECURITY & TAXES

The straight facts about how payments flow, what the app can and can't see, and what protects you — so you can answer a parent's “is this safe?” with confidence.

What the app never sees

When a parent pays you, their card information goes **directly from their device to Stripe**, the payment processor. It never passes through MI Little Care's servers. The app physically cannot access card numbers, bank or routing numbers, CVV codes, or expiration dates — that data isn't in its database in the first place. What's stored is only a display label like “Visa ending in 4242” and a meaningless Stripe token, so you and the parent can tell which card is which.

How a payment flows

1. You generate an invoice for a family.
2. The parent gets an email with a secure payment link.
3. They pay by card, Apple Pay, or Google Pay on a Stripe-powered page.
4. Stripe processes the payment and confirms it to the app.
5. The invoice updates to paid.
6. Money lands in your Stripe account, then transfers to your bank — typically about 2 business days.

The app never holds your money. It goes parent → Stripe → your bank. Stripe is PCI DSS Level 1 certified — the highest tier of card security — and processes payments for companies your families already use every day.

Autopay and disputes

When a parent enrolls in autopay, they authorize Stripe to charge their card on a schedule tied to your rate and billing day. They can cancel in a couple of taps, the consent is documented, and every successful charge is confirmed by email. If a card fails, Stripe retries and notifies both of you. If a parent ever disputes a charge, Stripe handles it directly with the card company; the autopay authorization on file serves as proof of consent.

The Form 1099-K

Stripe issues a Form 1099-K — an informational report of your gross payment income — once you cross the IRS reporting threshold for a calendar year. As of the 2025 tax year and beyond, that threshold is **more than \$20,000 in payments and more than 200 transactions** in the year. (This figure has changed repeatedly in recent years; the \$20,000-and-200 threshold was reinstated by federal legislation in July 2025.)

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR A SMALL HOME

Because the threshold requires *both* more than \$20,000 *and* more than 200 transactions, many small home providers won't receive a 1099-K at all — for example, if you bill a handful of families monthly, you may stay well under 200 transactions. If you do cross it, Stripe sends your 1099-K in late January for the prior year; give it to your tax preparer and pair it with the deductions you've tracked in the app. It's routine, not a problem. Thresholds can change again, so treat the exact number as current-as-of-2026 and confirm at filing time.

12 What's new in the 2026 rules

THE CHANGES EVERY LICENSED HOME SHOULD KNOW

Michigan adopted revised licensing rules for family and group child care homes on **April 27, 2026** (R 400.1901–1963). Providers have at least 90 days from adoption to come into compliance. The rules were renumbered and reorganized; here are the substantive changes most likely to affect your home.

Change	What it means for you
Higher capacity available	You may request an increase to 7 children (family home) or 14 (group home), up from 6/12, after holding a license for at least 29 consecutive months and receiving a renewed regular license. R 400.1925
Younger staff allowed	Child care staff members may now be 16+ (was 18); assistants are 14–15 (was 14–17). R 400.1920, 1921
Shorter record retention	Most records now retained 2 years (was 4). R 400.1906, 1907
CPR/first aid counts as training	CPR and first-aid hours now count toward your professional-development total. R 400.1924(5)
MiRegistry account required	All staff need a MiRegistry account within 30 days of employment; full MiRegistry verification of training is required on and after April 27, 2028. R 400.1922
Food allergy plan	A written food-allergy prevention and response plan is now required. R 400.1937
Expanded emergency planning	Your emergency plan must now include intruder/active-shooter procedures, alongside fire, tornado, flood, and the rest. R 400.1939
Fire extinguisher spec	At least one 2A-10BC (or larger) extinguisher, mounted no higher than 5 feet, on each child-use floor. R 400.1948
Teething necklaces banned	Teething necklaces, bracelets, and beads may not be used by children in care, indoors or out. R 400.1909
Formal licensing notebook	Keep a current notebook of the last 3 years of inspections, corrective-action plans, and approval letters, accessible to parents. R 400.1906(3)

WHERE MI LITTLE CARE ALREADY HAS YOU COVERED

Your app is built against this 2026 ruleset: the Compliance Checklist and Staff Training cite the new numbers, the intake packet captures the new licensing-notebook acknowledgment, and Reminders track the expanded drill and food-allergy requirements. The capacity increase, the new emergency-planning items, and the food-allergy plan are the areas most worth reviewing against your current practice.

This summary covers the changes most relevant to day-to-day operation; it is not the complete rule text. For the full adopted rules and the state's technical-assistance manual, see Michigan's Child Care Licensing Bureau rules page at michigan.gov/mileap → Early Education → Child Care Licensing → Rules and Statutes.

MI Little Care Provider Manual — Licensed Family & Group Child Care Home Edition. Rule citations reflect Michigan's licensing rules for family and group child care homes (R 400.1901–1963), adopted April 27, 2026. This manual is a guide to using the MI Little Care provider portal and a plain-language summary of related requirements; it is not legal advice and does not replace the official rules, your licensing consultant, or your tax professional. Tax thresholds described are current as of 2026 and may change.